

a regular cadence for 1:1 calls beyond onboarding

- If not already complete, discuss plan for taking over assigned customers / accounts
- Consider shadowing some customer calls and provide feedback as needed
- Confirm that new hire has completed all mandatory and necessary onboarding activities including SQS, role-based learning path and embedded required tasks, and GiLab core certifications
- Discuss how their performance will be formally evaluated in the future

Beyond 3 Months

- Provide regular feedback on performance
- Demonstrate curiosity as it relates to your new hire's career goals and aspirations and support them in their development
- Encourage your new hire to:
 - Build out an individual growth plan
 - Participate in knowledge sharing whether through team Slack channels, presentations, or enablement sessions
 - Participate in TMRGs that are of interest to them

Expectations for Buddy Support during Onboarding

Month 1

- Nurture a welcoming environment for the new hire
- Establish a recurring 1:1 to check in on the new hire's progress on onboarding activities
- Provide assistance with any barriers or difficulty understanding concepts covered in the onboarding learning path and SQS
- Connect the new hire with members of the broader team to build a network
- Share helpful tips and resources that are beneficial during their onboarding and beyond

Month 2

- Ensure new team member is actively engaged in ride-alongs and offer support as needed
- Align with new hire's manager on ways you can provide support
- Discuss any feedback, learnings, insights new team member has gathered throughout their onboarding experience
- Ask the new team member if they are experiencing any challenges and provide support accordingly

Month 3

- Inform new hire on how you can support them beyond their onboarding journey
- Share guidance around what resources you use in your day to day role as a SA and encourage new team member to bookmark and save these resources for future references

Graduation from SA Onboarding

In order to be considered as having graduated from your role based onboarding journey, you need to have completed the following:

- Completed Sales Quick Start (SQS) prework on GitLab University
- Attended the SQS workshop and completed all relevant activities
- Completed your role based learning path on GitLab University
- Shadowed calls with other SAs to prep for customer calls
- Attained the following certificates:
 - GitLab Certified Fundamentals
 - GitLab Certified CI/CD Associate
 - GitLab Certified Agile Portfolio Management Associate
 - GitLab Certified Security Specialist
- Created your own script and recorded demos for the following:
 - End to End Ultimate, Security Demo
 - Portfolio Management Demo (including Analytics)
 - GitOps Workflow Demo (Push-based and Pull based)
 - Compliance Premium Demo (Push-based and Pull-based)

Continuous Enablement

In addition to onboarding enablement, continuous enablement will be available to you via micro-learning, job aids, just-in-time learning, and webinars.

- Customer Success Skills Exchange is a biweekly webinar for the Customer Success and Solutions Architect teams on various technical topics
- Field Enablement Spotlight sessions take place weekly and cover topics relevant to the field

In addition to the above resources, you will also have access to O'Reilly, a learning platform accessible via Okta SSO.

Feedback

Your feedback on the onboarding process and materials is important to us and we welcome your thoughts and ideas on how we can improve in the future. Please share your feedback in the following issue: SA Onboarding Feedback Issue.

Updates to Onboarding

The role based onboarding learning path for SAs as well as the SA Onboarding Guide will be reviewed and updated each fiscal year to ensure up to date and accurate information. Please see the SA Onboarding Feedback Issue for information regarding the next planned refresh.

Resources and Links

- SA - New Hire - Onboarding Guide
- SA Onboarding Learning Path
- solutions-architects Slack Channel
- SA Onboarding Feedback Issue
- SA Highspot Page

SECTION: solutions-architects/sales-plays.md

Sales Plays for new account & teams(existing customer) lands

The SA should either be included in a discovery call or provided with Outcome / Infrastructure / Challenges information uncovered by prior interactions with the account. Occasionally, SA's may support a combination call of discovery and technical demonstration/deep-dive on a single call, but this is suboptimal as the latter approach does not allow the SA time to prepare for and/or tailor the discussion.

The SA is also responsible for any pre-sales technical customer inquiry or audit from associated accounts, including RFI, RFP or security audits. For details on the audit process, proceed to the Security page.

The SA is always responsible for drafting Professional Services SOW's, regardless of the account status (pre- and post-sales).

As a general guideline, no more than 2 Solutions Architects should join any single client-facing call, whether it be assistive for the topic or for learning / shadowing.

Overview

Objective - Land new accounts, logos & new teams in existing account with GitLab Ultimate.

Who is this sales play for?

- Primary: SAEs, SDRs and SAs who handle new accounts, new teams in existing customers
- Secondary: CSMs who help in discovery with new teams in existing customers

Who to meet

Ideal Customer Profile - Prospects or new teams in existing customers who are listed in this qualification list for enterprise customers

- Organizations/teams interested in shifting left & currently unhappy with their security tools OR not using security tool at all
- Organizations/teams unhappy with their deploy times, current operational efficiency, tool chain
- Organizations at lower maturity level undergoing or planning to undergoing transformation
- Siloed teams with disparate tools, especially security, lacking visibility at the individual level and executive level
- Organizations with stringent regulatory security or compliance requirements

Target Buyer Personas

| Persona role | Possible titles |

| ----- | ----- |

| Economic buyers | CISO or Security Manager, VP of Security, Director of Security, VP of IT or CTO, App/Dev Director |

| Technical influencers | Chief Architect, App Dev Manager |

| Other Personas to consider | Infrastructure Engineering Director, Release and Change Management Director |

Target Account Lists

- Account list

Getting Started

Consider the following questions:

- What has prevented the customer from moving to (or considering moving to) GitLab Ultimate?
- Does the customer have any strategic initiative or priority to which upgrading to Ultimate would align nicely?
- Are you engaged with the right personas/teams (see Target Buyer Personas above)?
- Do you have access to power/authority (a business decision maker)?
- Who are your champions within the account?
- Are the capabilities and PBOs that are enabled by GitLab Ultimate important to the customer? Why or why not? How do you know?

Stage: Qualification

Sales Play

1. For SAEs/SDRs please make sure the customers are on the qualification list for your region.

Eg: For enterprise west look at this

1. During qualification, make sure to identify the pain points, customer profile using the collaterals highlighted below:

1. Questions to better understand customer needs, future state & required capabilities

1. Customer presentations & GTM use cases link here

1. Discovery questions for GitLab Protect/Secure

1. Potential objections from prospects/customers

1. Review how to position GitLab's values & why does GitLab does it better here

Expected Outcome

Discovery

Owner

Primary: SDR, SAE

Secondary: SA

Stage: Discovery

Sales Play: New Customers(new logos)

1. Choose & create a list of discovery questions based on your customer profile in order to identify pain points

1. Discover the pain points through general discovery questions & resources below:

1. SA technical discovery questionnaire

1. Market requirements

1. Pick the ones that apply from value discovery pains, benefits & required capabilities

here

1. Discovery questions for customer currently not on secure/protect with specific entry points highlighted

1. Please review potential objections from prospects/customers before the meeting

1. Identify & get access to high-level DRI for security

1. Identify & get access to high-level exec for higher-level initiatives using collateral below

1. Accelerating Digital Transformation

1. Value Stream Management

1. GitLab is optimized for cloud native

1. Propose next steps & get some time while you are speaking with the customer ideally a demo or workshop. We DONOT recommend starting with a POV since it leads to longer sales cycles & unexpected results before doing more discovery & agreeing to success criterias.

Expected Outcome

1. Additional Discovery

2. Technical Evaluation ideally a demo or hands on workshop

Owner

SA and SAE

Sales Play: New Teams(existing customers)

1. Choose & create a list of discovery questions based on your customer profile in order to identify pain points

1. Discover the pain points through general discovery questions & resources below:

1. SA technical discovery questionnaire

1. Market requirements

1. Pick the ones that apply from value discovery pains, benefits & required capabilities here

1. Discovery questions for customer currently not on secure/protect with specific entry points highlighted

1. Please review potential objections from prospects/customers before the meeting

1. Please review all the this sales play if your customer is already on Premium

1. Identify & get access to high-level DRI for security

1. Identify & get access to high-level exec for higher-level initiatives using collateral below

1. Accelerating Digital Transformation

1. Value Stream Management

1. GitLab is optimized for cloud native

1. Propose next steps & get some time while you are speaking with the customer ideally a demo or workshop. We DONOT recommend starting with a POV since it leads to longer sales cycles & unexpected results before doing more discovery & agreeing to success criterias.

Expected Outcome

1. Additional Discovery

2. Technical Evaluation ideally a demo or hands on workshop

Owner

SA and SAE

Stage: Technical Evaluations

1. Strategize with your sales team on which play would you like to run & agree on the expected outcome before the meeting. We don't recommend starting a technical evaluation with a POV.

- Demo/Deck: Vision & transformation play, where you would likely focus on GitLab

holistically

1. Customer facing slides

1. Why choose ultimate

1. Customer proof point

1. How GitLab meets market requirements

1. Differentiators - Feel free to pick as many you would like

1. SA Demo Repo : break this down into multiple play

1. Demo catalog

1. End to End TCO planning workshop, Recording

1. [End to end demo with secure]

- Nuts/Bolts play where you will focus on specific secure/ultimate capabilities

1. DevSecOps Nuts & Bolts deck by Darwin Sanoy

1. Building a continuous remediation habit

1. Additional info including TCO workshop

- Demo/Deck: Integrate vs Compete play

1. Compete : Argo CD/TeamCity

1. GitLab advantages over competitors

Expected Outcome

1. Deeper Dive Demo

2. Workshops

3. POV

4. Professional Services Engagement

Owner

SA and SAE

Additional Resources to use

Will have specific resources under actions above. This is for additional resources.

- GitLab Ultimate specific features and value handbook page

- SKO Expanding to Ultimate slide deck

- Why GitLab Ultimate slide deck

- Selling DevSecOps resource page

- Selling security (need link) see John Blevin's online classroom material

- New Gartner MQ for Plan (Expected in May)

- Gartner MQ for AST (expected in May 2021)

Professional Service Resources

| Customer Persona | Services to Consider | Customer Desired Outcomes |

| ---- | ---- | ---- |

| CISO, CTO, VP Engineering, Director of DevOps Platform or Developer Experience, Head of Digital/DevOps Transformation | Transformative services, slides | reducing functional silos, proactive risk management (e.g. shift left), standardizing CI/CD workflows, and innersourcing collaboration. |

| Sr. Manager App Dev, Director of Engineering | Standard service packages or Custom Scoped Offerings| Customers who are interested in training on one ore more specific topic. Customers who need help in implementing GitLab Self Managed or need data to be migrated to GitLab |

Not sure? Get in contact with your region's PS Engagement Manager in professional-services to discuss specific customer opportunities.

Measuring progress

Please copy this checklist per opportunity & update as needed.

Consider these milestones and adjust stages in SDLC as you progress.

Milestones

- ☐ Gameplan with GitLab champion (MEDDPPICC)
- ☐ Meeting with Security team or other economic buyer
- ☐ Agreement to do technical evaluations
- ☐ Technical evaluations requirements defined
- ☐ Successful technical evaluation
- ☐ Proposal

Metrics:

- ☐ Avg days per stage to progress
- ☐ Longest step (common blockage?)
- ☐ Economic buyer titles - common factor?
- ☐ Retro on sales play

SECTION: solutions-architects/strategic-field-org.md

Solutions Architecture - Strategic Field Organization

The Strategic Field Organization is a team of Principal Solutions Architects that support global strategic prospects and customers. This team collaborates with the regional account teams to work together on large engagements that require a high degree of strategic planning - such as DevSecOps transformation, solution recommendations, and advisory for our customer's senior technical leadership.

Objective and Goals

The team's mission is to be the ambassadors for the strategic narrative of the platform and

engage with our strategic accounts' senior leadership team to provide technical advisory on solving critical business objectives with GitLab.

To achieve this, the team focuses on internal and external initiatives:

Strategic Customer Advisory

Partner with our account team and their strategic customers' leadership team to deliver advisory services that will enable them to meet their business objectives and get the most out of the GitLab platform. The approach to achieving this varies based on the industry and maturity of the organization's development practice. Example engagements include:

- Deliver roadmap and vision presentations to senior leadership - evangelizing why it exists, where it's going, how it fits in the market, and what critical business problems it solves for the customer.
 - Assess the technical and business impact through TCO and ROI, develop large-scale migration strategies, and provide cultural/workflow recommendations.
 - Develop and deliver executive-level advisory services for strategic prospects and customers who require a broader level of expertise than our offering.
 - Maintain ongoing cadence with technical leaders within a set of named strategic accounts.
- Represents the company at key industry and customer events

Technical Sales Strategy

As advisors to our largest strategic customers on DevSecOps transformation, the team can provide new approaches and strategies that allow our Sales and Solution Architecture team to increase value and efficiency when positioning GitLab as a solution. This includes:

- Assist in the development and execution of value-driven workshops and assessments (DevSecOps/DORA/Value Stream)
- Development of scalable and repeatable strategies to drive long-term customer value with GitLab
- Partner with the sales leadership team to formulate and execute a sales strategy to exceed revenue targets through the adoption of GitLab.
- Collaborate with product marketing, engineering, and management on a market strategy that results in an improved win rate.
- Assist in the positioning and delivery of industry analyst reports

Engagement Models

In the field, the Strategic field team focuses on two main engagement models:

Land at scale (new logos)

The core function of the team is to help drive larger, new logo opportunities. Due to the complexities of a large-scale organizational shift, we must provide a holistic approach to adopting GitLab. The strategic field team engages as an extension to the prospect's senior leadership to help bridge the technical and business impact.

Drive Ultimate adoption with existing strategic customers

As our existing customers continue to mature their DevOps practice on GitLab Premium, the Strategic field Team can assist with advisory services such as workshops and assessments (DORA, DevSecOps workflow, or Value Stream Mapping) to provide guidance. This allows us to help ensure they are getting the most out of GitLab and position the value of GitLab Ultimate as a future state and help drive their business results.

Engagement Process

Given the size of the team and the level of effort required, we have defined qualifications to maximize efficiency across our global accounts.

Qualifications for net-new deals:

- Deal opportunity ARR value is more than \$400,000 ARR
- Reviewed and approved by the regional ASM and regional SA manager
- Access to engage with senior leadership and the economic buyer

SECTION: solutions-architects/center-of-excellence/_index.md

Center of Excellence

To drive efficiencies throughout GitLab's Sales Organization while contributing to the broader GTM motion, an SA Center of Excellence will allow the team to expand GitLab's revenue opportunities. The team would be responsible for the following items, pulled in by other teams (e.g., CS, Field CTO, Field Enablement).

- Demo Architecture
- Business Value Services - driving our business value consulting efforts.
- Subject Matter Experts

All of the SMEs within the COE above will be 100% aligned to their respective areas of expertise. All Field SME Representatives are used to supplement these SME team members dedicated to their respective subject matter areas of expertise.

SECTION: solutions-architects/center-of-excellence/demo-architecture.md

Demo Architect Offerings

Term Definitions

Before we jump into all of the offerings we need to first cover definitions because how GitLab references workshops, labs etc. may not be the same as where you worked before:

- Workshop: this most often refers to a large online (or sometimes in person) event put on by the Field Marketing team. Goal attendance for these events would be around 250 students with a

full GitLab staff MCing and helping with questions. Realistically they are more like a webinar with hands-on exercises as the instructor does not directly interact with any of the students.

- Lab: Also called hands-on exercise, workshop etc. These are smaller, more personal events that fit into what you would traditionally call a workshop. The goal of these is to sell personalized content to a customer through an interactive hands-on activity that we have planned out.

- Demos: whenever this doc mentions demos it is talking about ready to go projects/scripts/videos that you can then use in your own calls. If there is no hands-on component that falls into the Demo category.

- Lunch & Learns: Primarily a term used by the CSE/CSM group to describe demos they give to a larger crowd. Will typically cover a topic like CICD in a short time frame with no hands-on portion. Almost all of the content here can be converted to this format.

- Cohorts: Term for a session put on by the CSE team that is halfway between a lab and a workshop. The content is typically a workshop focusing only on the important stuff, but also is in a setting where the students can ask questions live.

Workshops

Workshops are meant to be offered in 3 hour sessions (with a few exceptions) generally in partnership with the FFM team. This content often doesn't get very technical as workshops are open to the public resulting in many different skill sets, so we want to make sure everyone can still learn something from the events. If you are not currently partnered with the FMM team, you most likely are looking for a Lab instead.

The content in this section is typically updated at least 1 month after each release, with smaller updates provided before and after a workshop is ran.

GitLab Security & Compliance Workshop

- Slides

- Content

- What does it sell/cover: Ultimate heavy. The majority of this workshop is showing how to run Security scans in your pipelines & then enforcing compliance based off of the results.

- Extra Infrastructure Required?: No

- Other Security & Compliance Resources: Lab | Demo | Guided Trial | POV | Education Services | Professional Services

GitLab DevSecOps Workshop

- Slides

- Content

- What does it sell/cover: Ultimate heavy. This workshop is basically the Security & Compliance workshop minus the compliance plus deploying out a live application. 99% of the time it makes more sense to just run the Security & Compliance workshop.

- Cloud Infrastructure Required?: Yes

- Other DevSecOps Resources: Lab | Demo | Guided Trial | POV | Education Services | Professional Services

GitLab Advanced CI/CD Workshop

- Slides
- Content
- What does it sell/cover: Good for premium or ultimate. This workshop takes advanced topics (like DAGS, Includes, Needs, ETC) and presents them in basic ways. The goal is for someone new to CICD to get something out of the workshop and for experts to see how they can apply what they have learned to advanced features.
- Cloud Infrastructure Required?: Yes
- Other Advanced CI/CD Resources: Lab | Demo | Guided Trial | POV | Education Services | Professional Services

GitLab AI Workshop

- Slides
- Content
- What does it sell/cover: Ultimate heavy. Think of this workshop as a code suggestions workshop that also shows the students how to enable every other AI feature and test it out on their own. Always run this earlier in the week so that students have time to go back and see features like Suggested Reviewers.
- Cloud Infrastructure Required?: No
- Other AI Resources: Lab | Demo | Guided Trial | POV | Education Services | Professional Services

GitLab Basics Workshop

- Slides
- Content
- What does it sell/cover: Any Tier. We just focus on the basics of GitLab and the fact that it is one platform that ties many things together without taking a deep dive into any specific topic.
- Cloud Infrastructure Required?: No
- Other Basics Resources: Lab | Demo | Guided Trial | POV | Education Services | Professional Services

GitLab PM Workshop

- Slides
- Content
- What does it sell/cover: Good for Premium or Ultimate. Focuses only on the planning stage, so make sure that the students you have coming are not expecting a technical workshop.
- Cloud Infrastructure Required?: No
- Other PM Resources: Lab | Demo | Guided Trial | POV | Education Services | Professional Services

GitOps Workshop

Temporarily Paused, reach out to Logan Stucker with questions

- Slides
- Content
- What does it sell/cover: Good for both premium and ultimate. Real benefit of this workshop is

that it will set students up for how to use the agent for IAC or deploying an application. In the future we will be a deep dive into Flux as well.

- Cloud Infrastructure Required?: Yes

X to GitLab Workshop

(GitHub, Bitbucket, etc.)

- Slides
- Content
- What does it sell/cover: This can be many different topics but typically is GitHub or Bitbucket. The goal here is to take people new to GitLab and show them how easy it is to swap platforms and what they are missing.
- Cloud Infrastructure Required?: Maybe

Workshops Feedback/Survey Process

The goal is to set up a repeatable process for gathering feedback from workshop attendees while the experience is still fresh in their minds. We'll include a survey slide with a QR code, and the link will be shared in the chat just before the webinar wraps up. It will take less than 2 minutes to complete.

This is our first iteration, with plans to eventually automate the process. Over time, this feedback will help us identify areas for improvement, develop new materials, and refine how we deliver our workshops · ensuring we consistently provide valuable experiences for our attendees.

Follow the How to steps below to copy and generate your unique feedback QR code.

- How to Steps
- Survey Templates

Labs/hands-on Content

The goal of labs is to provide SA/CSM/CSEs with the ability to put on hands-on demos for a customer to land a sale without them having to go through all of the work to set it up. These have had tremendous success being the key to landing a first order or getting a customer to see the value in Ultimate. They are often a great replacement for a trial as well because we can do a hands-on exercise into a short trial to ensure they actually test out the functionality we want them to. Because of this the content often needs to be customised so there is no set template like the workshops or cs demos. Instead we often use those as a starting point for the final result we are trying to show. To request a lab you first need to fill out the form via Demo Architect Portal then one of the Demo Architects will set up and intro call with you to go over content and start the process. Below are some examples of past labs we have ran:

- Interactive Security Lab: The goal of this lab was to give the attendees a real life experience using GitLab to solve security problems. It was a small in person event, so we created an insecure project with many issues that were then assigned to various attendees. There was a short intro to GitLab + Security, followed by 2 hours of hands-on group work where

the students collaborated to secure the project with their assigned issues. This was then followed by a retro and wrap up which really drove the value home.

- Customer Lab Series: There was a customer that was partially using GitLab premium but still primarily a BitBucket account. A team of SAs + CSMs came together and gave a series of 20+ labs that walked through how to migrate off of BitBucket and onto GitLab followed by an in depth look at GitLab's Ultimate security features. This led to a huge up sell in both licenses and Ultimate.

- 0 to Hero Labs: This series of Labs has been running in the public sector where an SA will schedule an onsite visit and plan a day of labs. Morning is a PM and GitLab basics session to get everyone familiar with the product, followed by an afternoon session that is either hands-on/off and highlights all the best practices with GitLab Security. This has been a fantastic pipe generator specifically when you get people in the room that have never heard of GitLab mixed with existing customers. Because the sessions are so long there is plenty of time for discussion allowing people to discuss the true value of the product in their field.

Shared CS Demos

These demos are meant for anyone in the CS org to use when they get asked a question like "Hey can you show us how child pipelines work?" and instead of going out and re-inventing the wheel you have a catalogue of ready to go applications that cover the topic. The idea is that anyone can contribute, and it is up to the contributor to keep the content up to date and provide a decent script or recording to help you present the topic. Watch the CS & SA slack channels at the start of the month as well when we will announce the project of the month.

AI

AI

- Code Suggestions Python Demo: This demo takes the basic Simply Simple Notes application and shows how you can use code suggestions to quickly finish a restful API and rewrite an insecure application

- GitLab Duo Java Demo: This demo takes the simple application and shows how you can use the full potential of GitLab Duo to quickly remediate vulnerabilities and generate code faster.

Analytics

Analytics

- DORA Metrics Demo: This demo is meant to show how you can take advantage of the built in DORA metrics that GitLab collects as well as the VSA dashboard

CICD

CICD

- child-project: This is just a child pipeline used in the CICD-Samples project. Does not have a lot of use outside of being included in that demo.

- CICD Project: This demo will cover all of the CICD basics from DAGs to security scanners and templates. Check out the different branches for a finished section of each part.
- CICD-Samples: This project provides samples for different CI/CD scenarios, @samer.akkoub created and used it mainly to demo GitLab key CI/CD capabilities.
- Docker App Example: This project features a website built from a Docker image and deployed via GitLab CI/CD. The Docker image is built, then it is uploaded to the Container Registry, and the container scanning pulls the built image and conducts scans, then the application is published to GitLab Pages.
- Merge Trains: Basic CICD example to show off the power of merge trains
- monorepo: This project is a proof-of-concept for a monorepo application with 3 separate project folders that would like to run pipelines based on which project changes.
- secure-cicd-demo: The purpose of this repository is to demonstrate a CICD flow using a build-up of Binary Authorization Attestations with multiple Attestors
- sfdx-cicd-demo: Sample repo used in the webinar
<<https://developer.salesforce.com/docs/atlas.en-us.sfdxdev.meta/sfdxdev/sfdxdevcpackage-dev.htm>>
- sfdx-cicd-template: This project contains a fully configured CI pipeline that works with Salesforce DX projects following the package development model.
You can include a copy of, or import, this project's .yml file in your own project.
For a quick start example, please refer to sfdx/sfdx-project-template.

GitHub Competitive Demos

GitHub Competitive Demos

More to come soon!

Infrastructure

Infrastructure

- Automatic Labeler: Interacts with the label and api tester projects to run as a nightly script that applies all of the compliance framework labels to each project. Good demo to look at if someone is curious about using GitLab CICD to interact with the GitLab API.
- Cluster Management: Example cluster management project that some of the static demos use
- Demo Foundation: Terraform demo that will automate the process of spinning up a group + agent + cluster with GCP
- gitlab-cluster-management-eks: example Cluster management project specifically for EKS
- gitlab-cluster-management-gke: example Cluster management project specifically for GKE

- gitlab-iac-demo: This project can be used to demonstrate a GitOps pipeline that showcases features of Ultimate. It follows a similar workflow to a typical day-in-the-life development demo while integrating best of breed tools for Infrastructure as Code and configuration management.
- gitlab-terraform-eks: Terraform approach to the gitlab agent with EKS
- gitlab-terraform-gke: Terraform approach to the gitlab agent with GKE
- gitlab-terraform-gke-argocd: The purpose of this repository is to spin up a GKE cluster with ArgoCD pre-installed so you can configure your cluster through GitOps
- gitlab-terraform-gke-flux-config: Terraform example project for GKE using flux. Also interacts with the gitlab-terraform-gke-fluxcd project
- gitlab-terraform-gke-fluxcd: The purpose of this repository is to spin up a GKE cluster and configure GitOps with it using FluxCD
- gitlab-terraform-gke-fluxcd-apps: interacts with the gitlab-terraform-gke-fluxcd project
- GitOps Demo: Basic demo to show off how GitLab enables GitOps through our agent
- IaC Scanning: Support for IaC Scanning as of 14.5 powered by kics. Terraformed IAC scanner demo
- IaC Terraform: An IaC/GitOps Terraform project in GitLab to leverage built in GitLab functionality.
This project creates a GitOps pipeline to perform init, validate, build, and deploy stages to create an EC2 environment.
- IaC with Ansible: See how gitlab enables IAC with ansible
- Infrastructure As Code Scanning: Demo project for Infrastructure as Code Scanning introduced in GitLab 14.5.
- terraform-multi-env: This project is a proof-of-concept for a single project with 3 separate environment folders that would like to run pipelines based on which environment folder changes.

Project Management

Project Management

- Agile Demo: Group of a number of projects that show you how to use GitLab plan features with multiple projects in an agile way.
- PM Tools Demo: This demo has the same planning issues as the PM workshop for you to show off a number of our planning features.
- spring-sample: This demo walks you through how to show off the gitlab integration with Jira and even provides steps on how to spin up your own free jira instance.

Security

Security

- API DAST Security Scanner: DAST security scanners for graphql, har, openapi, postman, and soap
- API Fuzzing Security Scanner: Fuzzing scanner for graphql, postman, and soap
- Coverage Fuzzing Security Scanner: Lots of fuzzing examples for afl, cpp, go, heartbleed, java, js, python, ruby, rust, swift
- External Required Scans: This project identifies a single CI/CD YAML file that includes several scanners available for projects within the realm of the compliance framework. The goal is to identify a number of external scanners and scan results, providing a variety of results to the project that can then be acted upon.
- External Scans with C++ Compliance: This project provides a working example of C/C++ scanning utilizing a combination of GitLab scanners as well as external scanners. It was forked from the GitLab project providing an example for LibFuzzer scanner. As the LibFuzzer is pretty specific I felt this was a good launch point from where other scanners can be added.
- OWASP Juice Shop: OWASP security demo for gitlab. Practice before using as competitors have added traps for our platform.
- Security Dashboard Project: Static project that you can use look through the end results of a security scan
- Security Demo Project: Basic security demo that you can use to show how to add security scanners then parse the results
- Tanuki Trust: Large scale project great for not just showing off PM but also security and CI/CD. Fantastic for any customer that wants to see the full layout of what their group on gitlab.com may be

Shared CS Infrastructure

Shared CS Infrastructure

CS team members are constantly spending time re-inventing the wheel and spinning up infrastructure that their teammates have already done. The goal with this shared infrastructure is to eliminate that time waste allowing CS team members to focus on the integrations themselves instead of just how to get it to work. To get access you just have to fill out an access form for each project. Also feel free to fill out an enhancement form if you notice that the application is missing something you were hoping to show off (like a grafana plugin). Don't see a project you were hoping to use? Just create an issue on the Dev Issue Board and one of the SAs will pick up the task. Please note that there are two different types of infra, the first being applications that are easy to spin up without a high cost. Others like Snyk, Auth0 etc we will instead provide readmes on how to use their free cloud tiers or work around to give the demo but there are no plans to spin these up ourselves.

- Grafana
- Hashicorp Vault
- JFrog Artifactory
- Jenkins
- Remote Development Host
- Terraform GCP GKE
- Azure
- Jira

Live Talk/Keynote Resources

Live Talk/Keynote Resources

This group is full of slide decks and talk track you can take advantage of to give keynotes or public talks at various conferences. Often times these come with recordings as well so you can see what has worked for other employees in the past. These are not meant to be demo recordings, but rather talks around concepts and values of the GitLab product.

SECTION: solutions-architects/center-of-excellence/demo-systems-tos.md

Welcome to Our Demo Ecosystem

Our demo systems are valuable resources designed to help all internal team members throughout the sales cycle. See a full list of our supported systems here. We want you to make the most of these tools and encourage you to reach out for support whenever needed.

Important Boundaries

- Internal use focus: These instances are not intended as platforms to freely provide access and licenses to friends, family, or external parties who are not customers.
- Customer account restrictions: Outside of Learn Labs, customers should not be provisioned accounts on these instances due to potential exposure to red data.
- Exception process: We understand that special circumstances may arise with customers. In such cases, please contact the Demo Architecture Team first for approval.

Compliance

Team members who don't adhere to these guidelines may temporarily lose access to demo instances until the matter is resolved with manager approval.

What We Encourage

- Full utilization of all demo tools: These systems exist to be used! Don't hesitate to explore their capabilities.
- Learning through experience: Accidents happen! If you accidentally take down an instance or make an admin mistake while learning, that's completely fine when done in good faith.
- Not worrying about overuse: The platforms are built to handle your needs. There's no need to worry about using too many minutes or resources - that's exactly what they're there for.

- Asking questions: Our team is here to help. Reach out with any questions or for support when needed.

Support Contact

For questions, exception requests, or support, please reach out to the COE Demo Architecture Team in the internal demo-architect-partners Slack channel.

SECTION: solutions-architects/center-of-excellence/workshop-contribution-guidelines.md

Workshop Contribution Guidelines

Team Contributions

All team members are encouraged to contribute their pre-sales or post-sales workshops to be supported by the COE team's infrastructure. By doing so, your workshop will be added to Learn Labs, making it easy for you and other sales teams across the organization to repeat your events seamlessly. Contributing your content allows others to leverage your work and hopefully contribute back as well. We accept a wide variety of content types.

Guidelines

1. Broad Applicability: The content should not be specific to a single customer. It should be repeatable and relevant for any customer, regardless of region. Targeted vertical content is accepted and encouraged, but please keep in mind that others may use it for non-vertical customers as well. While it's acceptable to suggest multiple workshops focused on a specific topic like AI, please do your due diligence to ensure your content is not redundant with existing workshops. All existing workshop content will be viewable through the Demo Architect Portal and stored in the Learn Labs sample projects

2. Setup Instructions: If your workshop requires additional resource setup (e.g., attaching a cluster), please include clear setup instructions.

3. Styling Guidelines:

- Write all hands-on steps in Markdown, assuming they will be added as issues for the customer.

- Use bold for anything the customer needs to click.
- Use italics for anything the customer needs to look at.
- Include a title with [[TOC]] at the top of every issue.
- Number prep work steps starting at 0. Otherwise, start at step 1.
- Make code copyable when possible. For example:

&96;&96;&96;plaintext

How to enable experimental and beta AI features for GitLab Duo?

&96;&96;&96;

Requiring students to write out instructions often leads to problems.

- Link to relevant documentation when possible. For example:
 - > Docs for GitLab Discussion Summary
- For extensive code changes, provide a "finished" branch for each issue. For example if the goal of the exercise is to show a DAG, have a branch called "finished DAG" available on the project. Example
- Reference this sample file for guidance.

4. Things to Avoid:

- Stay within the GitLab platform whenever possible - including the use of the Web IDE versus local IDEs. Requiring customers to download separate IDEs or other tools can lead to issues with firewalls, versioning, and security.
- Avoid experimental or early development features, as they may have unexpected outages and frequent changes. If you must include one, clearly call it out in the instructions.
- Be mindful of workshop length. If it approaches 3 hours, consider breaking up the content.
- Prioritize accessibility for both slides and content. Ensure high contrast to avoid issues for people with color blindness.
- Currently, we do not support top-level group owner demos. Assume students will be owners of a subgroup but will have zero access to the top-level group.

Expectations

Once your workshop content is contributed through the Demo Architect Portal, the COE team will review it and work with you to get it polished and added to our infrastructure. We'll handle the technical setup so you can focus on delivering engaging workshops.

By contributing, you're helping build a valuable resource for the entire sales organization. We appreciate your collaboration in creating impactful, reusable workshop content. If you have any questions during the contribution process, don't hesitate to reach out to the COE Demo Architecture team for guidance.

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/_index.md

SA Opportunity Hygiene

This Section of the handbook describes all the processes Solutions Architects are either responsible for or are involved in, several of which require an updates and tracking in Sales Force, GitLab's record of accounts and opportunities.

To increase the SA's efficiency, a checklist of all SA's Opportunity updates has been created, to assist the SA, in keeping track their opportunity responsibilities on a weekly basis.

SA Process Maps

The SA organization uses process mapping as a framework for structured and continuous improvement. LucidChart is used to document SA execution workflow and details; in other words, what we do and how we do it is documented as a visual process map. This provides a single location to find reusable artifacts, enablement, and tooling.

The goals of SA process mapping are inclusive of the following:

- To be prescriptive and deliberate with SA activities in order to continuously increase efficiency and effectiveness
- Faster SA onboarding
- Make more of what we do measurable
- Hold each other accountable
- Make it easier to collaborate and iterate on what we did
- Create a repeatable process for all SAs to collaborate with our customers

SA process mapping is not meant to restrict creativity, experimentation, or improvement. As part of the SA Learning Organization, SAs are encouraged to challenge our mental models and focus on solving problems as a team. If something can be done better, please try it out and share your learnings. Contribute to our process maps and to the supporting handbook pages.

The following process maps are best viewed in full screen. Please note that many of the map nodes are clickable, leading to other maps, handbook pages, or other supporting artifacts.

`<iframe allowfullscreen frameborder="0" style="width:640px; height:480px" src="https://lucid.app/documents/embeddedchart/38e731ce-71cb-4e87-aaa5-d58bb78e1aad" id="z1uMS15~KGtS"></iframe>`

SA Activity Capture

Solutions Architects record all customer and prospect activity to promote transparency and collaboration. By consistently capturing our customer facing activity, we can perform analysis for further reporting to establish efficient decision making for GitLab's business. More information on this process can be found on the SA Activity Capture page.

We have a standard meeting notes document that is formatted to enable the activity capture in Troops which should be utilised for each customer engagement

Customer Success Plan

A Customer Success Plan is a customer-facing and mutually agreed roadmap for achieving value through GitLab adoption. This is an outcome of collaboration between GitLab Solution Architecture and the customer with the primary objective of ensuring customers are successful. The process is designed to support shifting from product scoped conversations (focusing on specific features or functions and limited to a specific subset of DevSecOps stages) towards solution (addressing specific pain points) or strategic (shaping business outcomes through holistic organizational process innovation and transformation tied to top strategic initiatives) scopes. This Success Plan starts in the pre-sales process and is intended to carry through to the post-sales Success Plan.

Note: While the Customer Success organization also has a Customer Success Plan for post-sales, with the intent of it being used as a customer facing document, so that updates can be made on post-sales initiatives and milestones, the Solutions Architect's Customer Success Plan process, intends to provide all the necessary context, and to capture the Customer's Voice, requirements and outcomes, in collaboration with the Customer during pre-sales, to ensure a smooth transition to Customer Success.

Customer Success Planning core goal is to identify and state:

- Business outcomes
- Key business stakeholders
- High-impact strategic requirements
- Current state of customer technology ecosystem (integrations required)
- Current and required capabilities
- Operational alignment with strategic objectives
- Perceived gaps and deficiencies in current capabilities
- Plan for implementing required capabilities and how GitLab can help

Positioning Professional Services

Solutions Architects should be pitching professional services at every qualified customer opportunity due to long term customer success and growth. Please use this deck and rubric to familiarize yourself with the catalog listed here.

Please add "Positioned PS" as SA activity type after you have positioned it for your opportunity.

Engaging Professional Services

Follow the process detailed in the Working with Professional Services handbook page.

Simplified process description:

- Ensure that PS Opportunity has already been created by SAE / AE in SFDC.
- If it is a standard (non-customized) service from our full catalog.
 - SAE / AE to order PS directly from Zuora in SFDC.
- If standard services do not meet the needs of the customer
 - Use the Services Calculator to generate an issue and a draft quote.
 - Iterate on that issue with PS and SAE / AE.

Customer Security Assurance

Follow the process detailed in the GitLab's Customer Assurance Activities handbook page.

Optional Considerations when engaging the Customer Assurance team:

- You can start with Security - GitLab Trust Center in some cases.
- Encourage customers to use and review Self-service Information Gathering.
- SAs can attempt a first-pass for all security questionnaires if time permits
 - Do it, it's fun and educational!
 - You can also make use of the GitLab's Trust Center
- Additional requests can be made in sec-fieldsecurity Slack Channel.
- When spending time on a security questionnaire ensure you capture the initial time dedicated via our SA Activity Capture system (troops).

SA Initiatives and OKRs

Solutions Architects record and track their OKRs (Objectives and Key Results) and Initiatives in the SA Initiatives GitLab project.

OKRs are directly related to the fiscal year SA focus areas as well as company OKRs.

Initiatives are independent of focus areas and OKRs.

Every Solution Architect can start a new Initiative and OKR as well as contribute to existing.

Both are ideally broken down to quarterly achievable efforts with DRIs (Direct Responsible Individual) for each action item as well as measurable deliverables (Key Results).

For documentation and tracking use the OKR and Initiatives template provided in the project and apply the corresponding labels.

At the end of the quarter each Initiative and OKR should be successfully closed, archived or moved to the next quarter if necessary. New planning starts at the beginning of the new quarter.

Cross-functional Sales Team Processes

Working Agreements

Enterprise Solutions Architects typically support sales teams made up of Sales Development Representatives, Strategic Account Leaders and Customer Success Managers. High Velocity Sales Solutions Architects support Mid-Market Account Executives and SMB Customer Advocates in a pooled model. When joining a sales team, establishing working agreements is critical to providing optimal service to the customers as well as the GitLab team. A sample template of working agreements is found below to help facilitate conversation and establish these agreements:

1. Customer response time for emails and meeting followups I will always do my best to provide same-day responses to customer inquiries and follow ups unless otherwise noted. I like to provide customers top-notch service, but interruptions can affect that target. I will use my out of office when traveling so customers can expect delayed responses during those times. Feel free to contact me if it's approaching the end of the day and you didn't see me address a customer request. Slack is the easiest way to find me most of the time.

1. Delivery Excellence If the nature of my response requires a top-notch service needing me to contextualise my response in better and higher quality to our customers, I will collaborate with my GitLab sales team and set reasonable timelines for completions. Examples could be customized and tailored summaries of technical guidance as per our documentation (not just a url), suggested reference solutions architectures, and/or integrations with third-party technologies to GitLab.

1. Calendar Schedule things as necessary right on my calendar during working hours - I'll do my best to keep my calendar up to date. However, if you see only one empty slot for a day or if it looks like the meeting would be back to back with something else, please check with me before confirming dates and times with the customer. If you want me at my best for you, I will need time to prepare and followup. If we schedule back to back, I've found I'm often late to arrive due to the last meeting, flustered as I context shift, lacking answers for known questions, unprepared with demo environments that were altered in the last call, etc.

1. Regular communication A weekly strategy hour-long call with the SA, SAE, SDR and CSM is preferred. If more frequent synchronous communication is desirable or required, we should work together as a team to identify a viable cadence, required attendees, convenient time and agenda for those calls. In either of those regular communication methods, documenting discussion points and agreements is essential.

1. Elevated conversations The more we focus on value and stay away from very deep technical and

troubleshooting conversations, the more I can help you achieve target sales. I'm happy to review and contribute to business plans and strategies so we remain in sync.

1. Professional Services After careful assessment of the clients needs to drive faster adoption, I'm happy to recommend and propose required services for prospects and customers. I will write the initial SOW and get approvals from the Professional Services team.

1. Travel While strategic enterprise sales absolutely require travel, each day on the road can increase the volume of work and calls on other days of the week as my dialogs with customers often require extensive time commitments to research and model specific customer solutions. Please plan strategically when looking at on-sites, considering that I support at least two sales teams in my region. Additionally, please work with the customer when arranging for an on-site (or F2F) visit with 1 week's notice. This will allow me to ensure my commitment to attend and take alternative arrangements for family and other matters if needed.

1. Notes Unless otherwise directed, external call notes with customers will be linked to a Google document from Salesforce and stored in the Gdocs "GitLab Sales" directory. Email communication with customers will also be bcc'd to Salesforce. If you prefer to record notes and actions differently, please let me know what that collaborative method is and I will link it to the SA Activity process.

1. Continuous learning Things at GitLab move really fast, and I need time to keep up. I'll block a few hours on my calendar coincident with releases to absorb the latest GitLab feature set, but new technologies and competitive products also appear regularly. Please expect that I will need to allocate additional time to learning about those on a regular basis to sufficiently support our customers.

Tool Usage within Cross-functional Teams

1. Salesforce

[To-do] Add info on views and reports to use during the sales cycle. Also, guidance on SA being listed on opportunities and accounts (there is not any info in our current handbook)

1. Slack Create a public internal team slack channel for your cross-functional team. This will allow you to collaborate easily without sending DM's.

1. Google Drive There is a shared GitLab Sales folder. Running customer notes and other documents related to a specific customer should be stored in the Customers and Prospects Subfolder under the appropriate letter and customer name subfolder.

1. **GitLab Account Management Project** may be used for a POV and/or CSM collaboration with a customer post-sale.

1. **Chorus.ai** is used to record meetings. The GitLab Notetaker will automatically join meetings with people outside of GitLab once your account is set up.

Account Planning

Account planning helps the SAE and the SA elevate opportunity-driven conversations into value-based conversations that focus on the customer's value drivers. It is a critical step in strategically supporting the customer at the account level, and facilitates more efficient opportunity planning.

Quarterly Exchange

At the end of a quarter, an SA team meets to share what they have been focused on to either share learnings or gather insights.

Goals

1. Collaborate, learn from, and improve upon each other's customer activities
1. Create a dialog to leverage each other's work
1. Grow closer as a team

Anti-goals

1. Perfection
1. Busy work
1. Another meeting

Format

15-30 minutes for each SA to either Reflect Back or Look Forward.

.. Reflect Back

Reflecting back on the past quarter, an SA can share what worked well or what should be avoided. A great way to facilitate this reflection and discussion is through Closed Opp Key Learnings or a Customer Strategy Plan.

Look Forward ..

Looking forward on the upcoming quarter, an SA can share a Technical Opportunity Plan to outline their strategy to secure a technical win and gather feedback and insights from team members.

Quarterly Business Reviews (QBR)

Solutions Architect Managers prepare QBR content by utilizing SA specific Dashboards, feedback from their SA and regional cross-functional teams, and through the Quarterly Exchange.

SAs should offer proactive assistance in matters related to articulation of technical win and success criteria details in the Notable Opportunities section.

Slides are stored in the Solutions Architects QBR folder in the appropriate quarterly subfolder.

Engaging an SA During the Sales Cycle

Solution Architects may participate in initial qualifying meetings (IQM's) or allow the SDR and SAE/AE to manage the initial call and utilize information gained during it for additional preparation. Teams can handle this on a case by case basis.

Once objectives and expectations have been established following the command of the message discovery, we suggest a recommended review as an account team of information gathered. This will help us determine if qualification criterias have been met to proceed with further technical discovery or that the account requires further discovery of their outcomes. Solutions Architects oftentimes will have a unique perspective in a given opportunity and it is vital that this information is distilled and shared out, preferably through the command plan, to the

rest of the account team.

The perceived size of a given opportunity is not always reflective of the amount of effort that an SA ought to put into a given customer. The requirements listed below are aimed at:

- Providing the SA to interface with as many opportunities as possible, by ensuring the proper preparation has been done prior to meeting with the customer
- Giving every customer increased confidence in the value they perceive through meeting with the SA and having them validate their plans
- Leveraging SAs exposure to opportunities to give SAs the autonomy to invest appropriate levels of time where they see the most amount of investment needed
- Reduce the onset of SFDC Opportunity confusion due to the lack of information provided or lack of in-depth knowledge within the varied technical domain(s) presented

When reaching out to engage SAs during opportunity qualification, discovery, and technical evaluations, please provide the below information. This will enable the SAs to accelerate execution, enable success, and promote consistent and quality opportunity outcomes aligned to the varied Sales roles and adopted strategies. The SAs reserve the right to decline the meeting if the below information is missing/not provided after being asked & if the correct personas are not engaged. We will review the exceptions on a case-by-case basis in case the below information is not provided and/or not qualified.

- Please provide active SFDC opportunity ID
- Please provide link to the associated and completed Command Plan
 - Ensure the Why Now?, Identified Pain, and Champion have been captured
- Any additional opportunity information (i.e. company overview and background, initiatives, desired outcomes, personas, etc.)
- Ensure that any scheduled or planned customer meetings have been discussed with the SA before customer engagement
 - What are we attempting to accomplish within the scheduled meeting?
 - Are the objectives clear and understandable?
 - Have expectations been managed and clearly discussed?

Poorly positioned opportunities where the SAs has been engaged at the wrong time or without enough context will lead to SA burnout, stalled or prolonged sales cycles, and misalignment with the customers needs. It is critical that SAs are engaged when the Command Plan is leveraged, specifically the Why Now/Identify Pain are in sentence format.

Solution Architects should participate in technical discovery after lead qualification is complete and in other activities during the sales process that lead to a technical win, e.g.

- GitLab demos
- GitLab technical deep dives
- GitLab hands-on workshops & Labs
- Whiteboarding sessions
- Prospect Q&A sessions
- RFI/RFP completion
- PoV planning, documentation and execution strategy
- Security Audits
- SOW Scoping with Professional Services

SA's may also work in tandem with a CSM to support existing customers, especially when expansion opportunities exist within the account. And SA's may also have regular touch points with smaller customers who do not have a CSM assigned.

SA/CSM Engagement Overlap

- On a high level note, SAs are the pre-sales advisors for our prospective as well as existing customers and CSMs manage the post-sales relationship of existing customers and are responsible for the GitLab adoption.

Further details can be found here: [Overlap Between Solution Architects and Customer Success Managers](#)

Technical Discovery and Demo Preparation

The Solutions Architect, in order to tailor conversations and demos to demonstrate value as well as address current problem areas, will want to understand the following information, and may request further technical discovery^[^footnote-01] prior to any demo:

1. Outcome:

- What's in it for the client?
- Why look at a new strategy for software development?
- What triggered the sudden client interest in GitLab?

1. Infrastructure:

- What tools are currently in place?
- What tools have potential to be replaced?
- What processes or workflows have potential to change?

1. Challenges:

- What problems/roadblocks have been uncovered?
- What current process or technology is being utilized for what software development reasons? (i.e. what purpose does the developed application have?, What language is it written in?)
- What is the current release velocity?
- What is the current planning process?
- What visibility, traceability or efficiency concerns exist?
- What collaboration or governance opportunities exist?
- What security or compliance inefficiencies exist?

^[^footnote-01]: Qualification criteria typically involve both Business requirements and Technical Functional/Non-Functional requirements (i.e, Functional requirements explain how the system must work, while non functional requirements explain how the system should perform.)

Once a technical discovery has been completed, SA will work within the account team to solidify a path forward (will the customer proceed with a purchase, trial, proof of value?) and identify the corresponding metrics that will be used to determine the success of the evaluation.

Solution Architect Engagement Models

U.S. Enterprise Account and Opportunity Engagement Model

The Enterprise Strategic SA Engagement Model intends to foster collaboration and influence an even greater iteration amongst ourselves and customers.

Given that Landed Addressable Market (LAM or LAM Dev) might not always be correct and the Opportunity Net ARR isn't always indicative of the potential, this model segments an SA team's engagement by the AE role, so that the SA engagement model is aligned with the AE team structures.

Solutions architects are responsible for owning their engagement on opportunities. The "engagement model" is a general recommendation, not a rule, and will be left to the discretion of the solutions architect.

For Major Account Executives, SAs are aligned with the account executives in their respective account activities.

For Strategic Account Executives, SAs are aligned with the account executives based on ongoing opportunities.

For Strategic Account Executives, the below process can be used to request a SA.:

- The Strategic Account Executives will click on the "SA Request" button in salesforce after creation of a qualified opportunity.
- This requires information regarding the customer's pain points, why now and any additional information needed to get SA help.
- This information is pre filled from command plan and close plan if it exists. If this doesn't exist, then this will also be added back to the command plan and close plan
- This request is triaged through a slack channel and will be accepted by a SA which will populate the Primary SA field.
- The turn around time for a SA allocation is 24 hrs.
- Enterprise SAs will be dedicated through out the lifetime of the opportunity.
- Retaining SAs for multiple opportunities throughout the life cycle of an account or dedicated SA for SAE will be at SA/ASM manager discretion.
- The SA/SAE alignment will be visible on a report

Async Slack support

In some cases SA support might be required in early stage or not fully qualified opportunities. Slack can be used for answering technical questions, providing additional customer outreach materials or helping an Account Executive with a narrowly-scoped customer inquiry. These requests can be served asynchronously via Slack:

AMER EAST: us-amer-east-sa-support

AMER WEST: us-amer-west-sa-support

These Slack channels are considered to be a safe harbor for all enterprise AE <-> SA communication. When asking questions, please ensure you provide as much context as possible;

including the SFDC URL, and type of subscription (SaaS or Self-Managed). Solutions Architecture will monitor and provide best effort support on these requests.

EMEA Account Engagement Model

EMEA Enterprise Solutions Architects support the Major Account Executives (MAE) as well as the Strategic Account Executives (SAE) with an alignment model.

SAs are regionally aligned to AEs and aligned in their respective account activities. Each team collaborates according to standard Working Agreements, but they can be adjusted by teams individually.

Default alignment is maintained in the EMEA AE-SA Alignment page.

When workload exceeds the SA's capacity or when there is a request from other departments, please reach out via [emea-customer-success](#) Slack channel for assistance.

High Velocity Engagement Model

SA engagement for customer interactions, RFP's, audits and more (how to engage a High Velocity SA) can be requested by a Mid-Market Account Executive or other GitLab team-member using the SA Request button on the Salesforce Opportunity. Find more information about engagement considerations, triage process and expectations in dedicated High Velocity Solutions Architecture Engagement Model handbook page.

APAC Account Engagement Model

APAC SAs are aligned regionally into regions such as ANZ, SEA (South-East Asia), India, South Korea and Japan in close alignment to the Strategic Account Leaders, Commercial AEs and Channels Managers territories. Teams collaborate to the standards Working Agreements.

Ecosystem SA Engagement Model